

Module 01: Systems — The Family System

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that a **Family** is a System made of people.
2. Learn that systems have **Parts** (Parents, Kids, Pets) and **Connections** (Love, Rules, Talk).
3. Know that if one part changes, the whole system changes.

Introduction: We Are A Team

A car is a system of wheels and engines. A forest is a system of trees and animals. A **Family** is a system too! You are not just one person. You are part of a team.

- **The Parts:** Mom, Dad, You, Baby Brother, Dog.
- **The Connections:** Who cooks dinner? Who plays games? Who gives hugs?

In a system, everyone matters. If one person is grumpy, the whole house feels grumpy. If one person is happy, the whole house shines!

Key Concepts

1. The Mobile (Balance)

Imagine a hanging mobile (like for a baby). If you pull one string, *everything* moves. A family is like that.

- If Mom gets a new job -> The schedule changes.
- If You get sick -> Dad stays home. We are all connected.

2. Boundaries (The House)

Every system has a boundary.

- **Inside:** Your family, your rules, your safe space.

- **Outside:** The world, school, neighbors. The boundary keeps the system safe but lets good things in (like friends and pizza!).

3. Energy (The Battery)

Systems need energy to work.

- Cars need gas.
- Families need **Love, Food, and Sleep**. If the "Family Battery" is low (everyone is tired), the system doesn't work well. We need to recharge together!

Activities

Activity 1: The String Web

Sit in a circle. Hold a ball of yarn. Toss it to someone and say "I love you because..." Keep tossing until everyone is holding the string. Now, one person pull the string. Does everyone feel it? We are connected!

Activity 2: Family Roles Map

Draw your family. Draw lines between people to show what they do for each other.

- Mom -> Cooks for -> Me.
- Me -> Feeds -> The Dog.
- Dad -> Reads to -> Me. See how busy and helpful your system is!

Summary

A family is a living system. We are different parts working together to make a happy, healthy home. When we understand our system, we can take better care of each other.

References

- *The Family Book* by Todd Parr
- *Thinking in Systems* by Donella Meadows (For Parents)